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CFO-ORC FILE # _____

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

Rcd 12/28/00 wpl

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: Blue-headed Vireo | Vireo solitarius
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): 9 September 2000Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: ? Plumage: Adult?Locality: Poudre River Bike Trail n Prospect Rd. Elevation: 5000'Nearest town: Fort Collins County: LarimerTime(s) observed: 4 PMDuration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): 15 minutes

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

none

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers)

none

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

good (from behind me)Optical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 8x42 B&L ElitesDistance, and how measured: 20 feet

If photographed, type of equipment and film: _____

Who else photographed the bird? _____

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

foraging in willow on *Brachyura* sp. stickbugs. Also in cottonwoods.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observe in the field:

Vireo. Bill thicker than that of warbler. Head dark gray with hint of blue. Back greenish-gray. Breast white with hint of blue. Back greenish-gray. Broadest part of eye-ring broken in the lower area. Broadest part of white ring in front of, and above, middle of eye. Wings greenish-gray @ two bold wing bars. Breast white. Sharp contrast between white breast/throat and dark gray side of face. Good contrast between head (gray) and back (green). Flanks bright yellow, incl. yellow vent area. From below the yellow went completely across vent/lower belly area; extended somewhat to under tail coverts. Tail gray-green. Legs gray.

Description (continued):

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

Silent

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

Riparian woodland (cottonwood, willow, R. olive, green ash)

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

Strong head-back contrast, extensive yellow on flanks & vent, sharp demarcation of head-throat was too bright for Cassin's Vireo (3 Plumbeous) Not dark enough head for Black-capped Vireo (also wings white)

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I have seen several "Blue-headed Vireos" in east and four in CO (prior to this one). I have seen about 10 Cassin's Vireos in CO.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: usual Nat'l Geo etc

Birding magazine (Dec '96) = XXVIII, No 6

This report was written from reports made during X, after observation X from memory

Date and time report was written: 20 September 2000

Reporting observer: David Leatherman Signature: David Leatherman

Address: 612 Storer St # 7 Fort Collins CO 80524